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HEADQUARTERS
SUB-REGION FRANKFURT
COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS REGION III

APD 757

20 November 1947

III-FM-6344

SUMMARY REPORT OF INVESTIGATION

SUBJECT: Walter & Riemar HORTEN

Cross Reference: Flying Saucers

Case Classification: Aircraft Development

1. Reason for Investigation: Reference is made to letter from headquarters 970th Counter Intelligence Detachment, EUCOM, file No. D-138239, Subject Flying Saucers, dated 28 October 1947, in which information regarding the whereabouts and present activity of the HORTEN brothers and information about their research in aeronautical design is requested.

2. Synopsis of Previous Investigation: No previous investigation has been conducted by this office.

3. Synopsis of Present Investigation: Former Luftwaffe personnel were interrogated in the course of this investigation as a likely source of information. The HORTEN brothers are completely unknown to them.

a. On 16 November 1947 in FRANKFURT (L51/K67), Dr. Hugo ECNER, builder of the Graf Zeppelin, was interviewed and he stated that he had never heard of the HORTEN brothers or the planes which they are said to have designed. Dr. ECNER, however, pointed out to this agent that he had never been in the good graces of the Nazis and it is entirely possible that the HORTENs had been conducting aeronautical research during the war without Dr. ECNER being aware of it. (Evaluation: A-2)

5USC552 (b) (6) & (b) (7) (C)

b. Rudolf SAUTER, [REDACTED] former chief engineer of the Zeppelin HINDENBURG and the GRAF Zeppelin, was also questioned. SAUTER, who was a technical director of Junker Aircraft during the war, stated that if the HORTEN brothers had ever attained any prominence in aeronautical research, he, SAUTER, or his friend, General of the Luftwaffe Ernst UDET (now deceased), would have been informed of their activities. SAUTER was unable to give any information about a flying wing type plane called the Horten VIII and is very sceptical about the existence of such an experimental aircraft in Germany. (Evaluation: B-2)

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4. Undeveloped Leads: There are no undeveloped leads.

5.- Agent's Comments and Conclusions: All sources of information contacted in this area indicate that the existence of the HORTEN brothers as a big influence in German aeronautical research is highly questionable. In view of the fact that the Air Intelligence Guide enclosed with the letter referred to in paragraph one (1) of this report lacks evaluation, it is requested that the information be evaluated if any further investigation is desired.

6. Recommendations: There are no recommendations.

APPROVED:

Arthur B. Conoley for
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